

40–50 cm
16–20 in



BLACK SKIMMER
Rynchops niger
F: Laridae

Skimmers are the only birds with projecting lower bill mandibles, used to skim water for fish. This species is found in N. and S. America.

BROWN NODDY
Anous stolidus
F: Laridae

Noddies are dark or white tropical members of the tern family. The largest species, the brown nody is widespread around the world.

40–45 cm
16–18 in



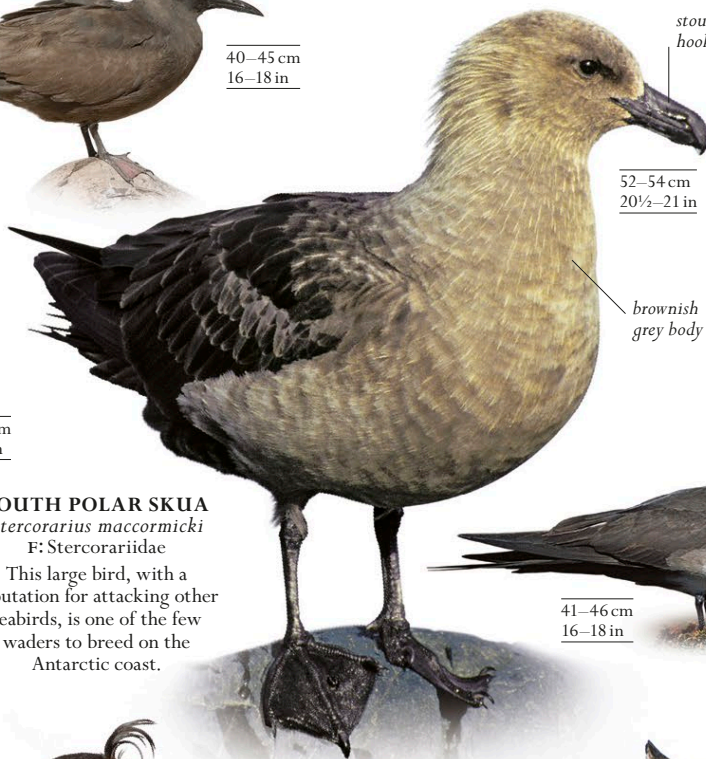
46–51 cm
18–20 in



POMARINE JAEGER
Stercorarius pomarinus
F: Stercorariidae

Jaegers (also called skuas in Europe) are aggressive gull-like birds. This Arctic species will kill and eat other seabirds and even attack humans that threaten its nest.

52–54 cm
20½–21 in



SOUTH POLAR SKUA
Stercorarius maccormicki
F: Stercorariidae

This large bird, with a reputation for attacking other seabirds, is one of the few waders to breed on the Antarctic coast.

brownish
grey body

41–46 cm
16–18 in



PARASITIC JAEGER
Stercorarius parasiticus
F: Stercorariidae

This is the commonest Arctic species of jaeger. Like most of its relatives, it mobs other seabirds to steal their prey.

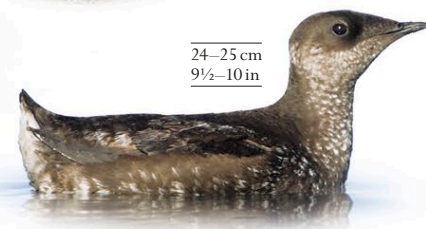
48–53 cm
19–21 in



LONG-TAILED JAEGER
Stercorarius longicaudus
F: Stercorariidae

Like other species, this smallest member of the jaeger family is migratory. It breeds in circumpolar regions and winters further south.

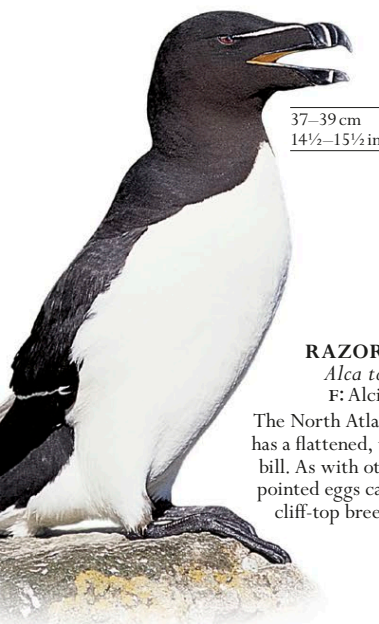
24–25 cm
9½–10 in



MARBLED MURRELET
Brachyramphus marmoratus
F: Alcidae

This small American auk nests in trees in coniferous woods. Fledged chicks leave the nest at night and make for the sea.

37–39 cm
14½–15½ in



RAZORBILL
Alca torda
F: Alcidae

The North Atlantic razorbill has a flattened, white-barred bill. As with other auks, its pointed eggs cannot roll off cliff-top breeding sites.

24–27 cm
9½–10½ in



CRESTED AUklet
Aethia cristatella
F: Alcidae

Like other auklets, this North Pacific species feeds on planktonic crustaceans. Pairs anoint themselves with secretions from their backs during courtship.

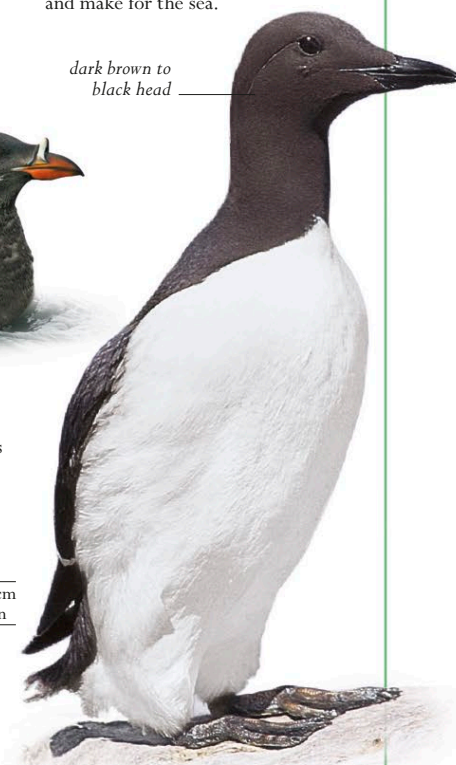
17–19 cm
6½–7½ in



LITTLE AUK
Alle alle
F: Alcidae

This tiny auk breeds on Arctic islands and winters at sea further south. It feeds on tiny fish and crustaceans.

dark brown to
black head



GUILLEMOT
Uria aalge
F: Alcidae

A typical diving member of the auk family, this bird breeds on North Atlantic and Pacific coasts, and winters at sea.

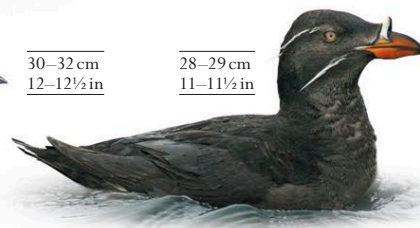
30–32 cm
12–12½ in



BLACK GUILLEMOT
Cephus grylle
F: Alcidae

This species of northern N. American and Eurasian coasts breeds in sparser colonies than other auks and winters mainly inshore.

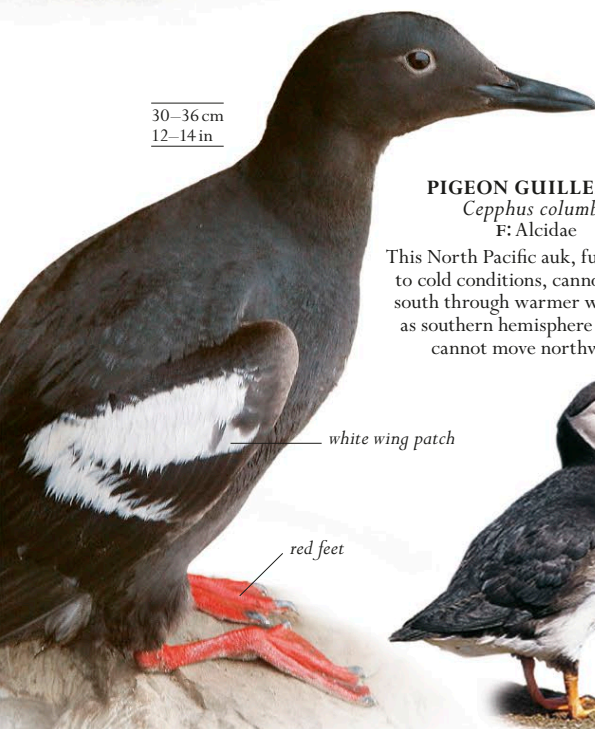
28–29 cm
11–11½ in



RHINOCEROS AUklet
Cerorhinca monocerata
F: Alcidae

This North Pacific relative of puffins shares their burrow-nesting habits, and is named for the horn-like bill projection in breeding adults.

38–41 cm
15–16 in



PIGEON GUILLEMOT
Cephus columba
F: Alcidae

This North Pacific auk, fully adapted to cold conditions, cannot migrate south through warmer waters, just as southern hemisphere penguins cannot move northwards.

white wing patch

red feet

26–29 cm
10–11½ in



ATLANTIC PUFFIN
Fratercula arctica
F: Alcidae

A small, North Atlantic member of the auk family, this species—like other puffins—nests in colonies, in burrows, usually below turf.

34–36 cm
13½–14 in



TUFTED PUFFIN
Fratercula cirrhata
F: Alcidae

Like its Atlantic relative, this larger Pacific puffin catches small fish and can hold many at a time, crosswise, in its bill.